HUGO AFFATICATI

Senior TPM Manager — AI Infrastructure & Model Launches
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Technical Program Manager with 5+ years leading end-to-end launches of AI models and infrastructure at Microsoft, spanning research, engineering, product, and infrastructure teams. Deep technical fluency across model post-training, evaluation, and serving; proven track record compressing launch timelines, managing complex cross-team dependencies, and driving executive alignment under ambiguity and pace.

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft AI **Seattle, WA, USA**
Principal TPM Manager *Jun 2026 – Current*

- TPM for Evaluation Quality and Platform workstreams supporting MAI-Thinking model development and launches across Microsoft AI — partnering with research, engineering, product, legal, marketing and leadership to sequence evaluations, manage dependencies, and prepare launch plans for model releases.
- Led cross-functional AI evaluation program, driving the MAI Index as the north-star quality framework for thinking and code model launches; coordinated benchmark coverage, competitive comparisons, and weekly leadership reviews to give actionable visibility into model capabilities, gaps, and launch readiness.
- Drove evaluation-platform modernization, completing a 25-benchmark migration and reducing runtime for the migrated evaluation suite by 23%; partnered with engineering to deliver 99.95% evaluation uptime, accelerating reliable feedback for foundation-model development.

Microsoft (Copilot) **Seattle, WA, USA**
Senior TPM Manager *Jan 2026 – Current*

- Led cross-functional launch program across 6 teams, delivering 21% cost savings on chat tokens by driving GPU utilization and Response Quality workstreams — coordinating context/prompt improvements, infrastructure optimizations, and tool-call tuning, and running weekly standups and executive escalations to keep launches unblocked and on track.
- Program-managed infrastructure launches distributing 1,000s of GPUs across 10+ teams and 25+ experimental flights to ship new products and features; restored chat latency to SLA by redistributing capacity and authoring PRDs for UI/UX integration, navigating dependencies across product, engineering, and infrastructure stakeholders.
- Compressed a Safety model launch timeline from 3+ months to 7 weeks by architecting a parallelized, reusable cross-functional process — PRDs, RFCs, review cycles, and dedicated capacity across fine-tuning, evaluation, and serving — establishing a playbook that let subsequent launches ship in ~3 weeks end-to-end.
- Partnered with research and engineering to launch an upgraded Image Generation model, benchmarking latency against user engagement to set launch criteria — delivering hundreds of GPUs in savings and measurable retention gains.
- Owned the multi-million-dollar Human Evaluations program underpinning pre-launch model quality assessment — consolidating fragmented vendor and team processes into an org-wide solution, introducing dashboards and automated support, and closing compliance gaps.
- Built and scaled an internal feedback-triage agent processing hundreds of tickets weekly, feeding directly into the AI product fix flywheel — hands-on technical contribution alongside program leadership.
- Hired 4 TPMs in 4 weeks (JD to start date), running the full loop and reviewing 100+ resumes; helped define the TPM function for the organization.

Microsoft (Azure) **Seattle, WA, USA**
Senior Cloud Infrastructure Engineer *Sep 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Delivered record-setting throughput of 865,000 and 1.1M tokens/sec for LLAMA 70B inference on GB200 and GB300 racks — featured in Satya Nadella's Build and Ignite keynotes and recognized by NVIDIA at GTC.
- Closed a 20% performance gap across 14 AI training models (NeMo framework) in three weeks after six months of stalled progress, leading 50+ engineers from Microsoft and NVIDIA through full-stack root-cause analysis.
- Owned end-to-end MLPerf Training submission on 512 H200 GPUs — architecting scalable infrastructure, delivering 28% cost savings, publishing peer-reviewed results, and managing vendor/partner engagement.

- Authored competitive intelligence reports to Microsoft SLT analyzing 1,000+ accelerator performance data points, informing partner strategy and contributing to seven new $M+ customer contracts.
- Mentored five full-time engineers and two interns (both returned) as Technical Lead for the workloads team.

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer II *Mar 2024 – Aug 2025*

- Developed and launched the AI Benchmarking Guide, standardizing cloud AI infrastructure performance across hardware vendors, leading a cross-company team of 15 engineers to drive industry adoption.
- Reduced generative AI inference latency 46% on LLAMA models by optimizing model configuration to fully leverage next-gen GPU architecture, cutting cost for enterprise customers.
- Represented Azure's AI infrastructure work via two invited technical talks (NVIDIA GTC, SC24) and three on-demand videos.

Technical Program Manager II *Sep 2023 – Feb 2024*

- Managed the Microsoft–NVIDIA program that set the LLM training scale record on Eagle, driving planning, testing, and release across research, product, and engineering stakeholders.
- Benchmarked Microsoft's H100-based VMs against NVIDIA's NeMo Megatron and MLPerf suites to establish performance and TCO standards for enterprise Generative AI customers.

Technical Program Manager I *Sep 2022 – Aug 2023*

- Executed the first public proof-of-concept for cloud-scale LLM training (GPT-3, 530B parameters) using NVIDIA NeMo — a launch that helped catalyze industry-wide AI infrastructure investment, including OpenAI's move to Azure.
- Headlined Microsoft Build (most-attended technical talk) and SC22 on AI infrastructure capabilities.

Program Manager *Aug 2021 – Aug 2022*

- Led Microsoft's MLPerf Training and Inference submissions, optimizing Linux/Python ML code on A100 GPUs to demonstrate leading performance, latency, and accuracy.
- Decoded AI workloads through writing 15+ technical blog posts and documentation (approx. 35k views) for beginners.

KARL Tech (startup) **Bordeaux, France**

Co-founder, Entrepreneur, CEO *Mar 2019 – Apr 2020*

- Built and launched color-rendering software for online retail within a 3-month incubation at Station F; exhibited to decision-makers at CES 2020 with France's official delegation.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Microsoft — Chair, LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Groups (Southeast & Azure Core) **Mar 2022 – Current**

- Lead a 13-person leadership team and a global 6-person board; tripled annual budget to $30,000 through cross-ERG partnerships; received Microsoft's Leadership Award (2023) for highest membership and budget growth.
- Managed a 13-person leadership team and a global six-person board with bi-weekly meetings and dedicated mentorship.
- Tripled annual budget to $30,000 by starting strategic partnerships between Microsoft's ERGs (geo and business based).
- Built a community with quarterly morale events and monthly safe-space meetings to improve D&I culture at Microsoft.
- Received Microsoft's Leadership Award for cultural impact in 2023 (highest membership growth and budget growth).

EDUCATION

Yale University Graduate School of Arts and Sciences — MS in Applied Physics 2020–2021

Research: Magic State Fidelity for Quantum Computation Optimization with Prof. S. Puri

Improving precision for Optical and Quantum Electronics with entangled photons with Prof. P. Rakich

Adapting Maxwell's equation for a general laser theory with Prof. A. Stone, Deputy Director of Yale Quantum Institute

Paris Saclay University, Institut d'Optique Graduate School — BS/MS in Engineering & Quantum Physics 2018–2020

BS GPA: 3.97/4.00 and MS GPA 4.00/4.00, Mentored by Nobel Prize-winning physicist Gérard Mourou

Relevant coursework: Atomic Physics, Quantum Mechanics, Fourier and Non-linear Optics, Experimental Research

PSL University, Université Paris Dauphine — BS in Applied Economics, 2019–2020

Bachelor in Applied Economics, condensed into one year, for students of Top Engineering Schools

Relevant coursework: Macroeconomics, Microeconomics, Econometrics, and International Economics